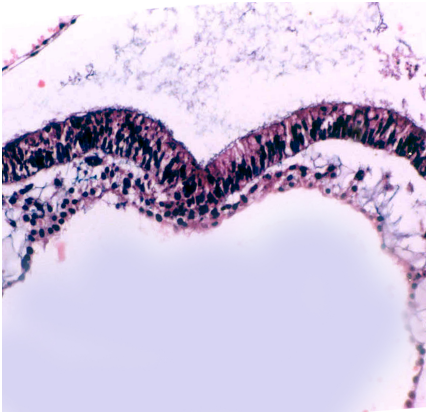




YOU ARE **4 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

249 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

As the embryo transforms from two cell layers into three, a groove develops along the back of the embryo. This groove (the dark area in the center of this image) will develop into the embryo's neural tube—the forerunner of the brain and spinal cord.

“Happy? Excited? But a little nervous? There is no greater life-changing event than finding out you’re going to have a baby.”

In the few days since you conceived, you may have experienced a whole host of different feelings. Even if you planned to get pregnant, it's perfectly normal for the initial elation to be replaced with some anxiety as the reality hits you that you are going to have a baby. You might also doubt the result of the test you've taken and not actually believe it until you begin to have some of the early symptoms of pregnancy.

Your partner may react differently than you. If they don't appear as excited, don't interpret this as meaning that they are not happy about the news; not everyone deals with big events in the same way, and it might be some time before the reality of becoming a parent hits them. Withdrawing may be their way of processing the information. Conversely, you may find they are actually more excited about the news than you!

Handling your feelings might be made more difficult by trying to keep the pregnancy a secret, for the time being. Most couples decide not to tell people until after the 12-week scan when the miscarriage risk is significantly decreased, but you may find that confiding in a few close relatives and friends will give you a much-needed outlet to talk about your feelings.

CONNECTING THROUGH DREAMS

Pregnant women often try to connect with their baby through dreams. You may find it difficult to bond fully with your baby and believe you're actually pregnant. A common dream in pregnancy is that you're swimming; it is thought to be a way of trying to “reach” the baby, who will soon be bathed in water (fluid) inside you.

SURPRISED TO BE PREGNANT?

If you become pregnant while using contraception, it is unlikely to have done your baby any harm, but here's what you should do:

- **Contraceptive pill:** stop taking it.
- **Contraceptive patch:** remove it.